

My Personal Care Plan

Original worksheet by Sophia Cohon, PhD

Choose one routine. Find what makes it hard, then try a support you want.

What do I want to make easier?

What counts as good enough?

Find the friction

☐ Starting	☐ Remembering	☐ Too many steps
☐ Pain	☐ Fatigue	☐ Sensory discomfort
☐ Privacy	☐ Body discomfort / dysphoria	☐ Missing supplies
☐ Time	☐ Motor demands	☐ Not sure yet

Build the route

First My first move 	Then What comes after 	Next The next step 	Done Good enough
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Match support to friction

☐ Visual checklist	☐ Supplies laid out	☐ Reminder
☐ Same time / place	☐ Different product	☐ Temperature change
☐ Gloves / tool	☐ Music / audio	☐ Sit instead of stand
☐ First step together	☐ More privacy	☐ Shorter version
☐ Rest break		

A sensory change I want

Help I want

Help I do not want

How I will know it helps

If care suddenly gets much harder, check health, pain, mood, sleep, and access with the right professional. Do not assume it is only a habit problem.

Make the routine workable

For a clinician or support person

Plan around the person's priorities, access needs, and choice. Success may mean less effort or more control over the routine.

- Watch where the routine gets stuck. Offer one change at a time.
- Ask before helping, touching, or changing products. Keep the person's privacy and choices central.
- Keep helpful access supports available. Consider medical or occupational-therapy input for pain, motor demands, or persistent difficulty.

Choose one next step

Where the routine gets stuck

One change we will try

What can be ready in advance?

What my helper and I agree to do

What should we watch next?

What was easier or more under my control?

What will we keep, change, or check next?

About this worksheet

Original planning tool; not a validated assessment or a reproduced outside worksheet. The sources support the general guidance, not validation of this tool. Guidance checked October 3, 2026.

National Autistic Society: sensory processing and support

When Hygiene Tasks Are Hard | short guide